Bridge Trust and Safety Operations Guide

Pilot operations guide | Version 1.0 | 2 November 2026

Purpose

Bridge connects students and task owners through profiles, task listings, applications, and chat. This guide proposes operational controls for a limited pilot. It is a product operations document, not legal advice or a final policy. No moderation, verification, reporting, or dispute flow is visible in the Stitch screens; these capabilities need an accountable owner before broad access.

Trust objectives

- Keep task information clear enough for participants to make informed choices.
- Reduce impersonation, spam, misleading listings, harassment, and unsafe requests.
- Give users a predictable path to report a concern and receive a response.
- Restrict staff access to operational need and record material interventions.
- Avoid using "verified," ratings, or quality badges without a defined and supportable basis.

Risk categories

Category	Example indicators	Initial response
Misleading task	Vague deliverable, changing scope, hidden budget conditions, unrelated data requests.	Pause promotion; request clarification; review applicant impact.
Impersonation or account abuse	Account identity appears copied, suspicious changes, repeated account creation.	Restrict high-risk actions while reviewing; do not expose reporter details unnecessarily.
Harassment or inappropriate contact	Threats, repeated unwanted messages, coercive behavior.	Prioritize safety; restrict contact where available; escalate to trust owner.
Spam or manipulation	Repeated irrelevant posts, fake applications, attempts to move users to unsafe channels.	Limit activity and review patterns; preserve relevant records.
Data exposure	User reports private information in a public profile, task, or message.	Limit further exposure where possible; route to technical lead and trust owner.
Work/payment dispute	Disagreement about scope, quality, completion, or payment.	Acknowledge and document; do not promise adjudication until Bridge's role and process are defined.

Reporting intake

Until an in-product report flow exists, publish one monitored pilot contact and an escalation backup. Intake should capture: report reference, time received, affected task/conversation/account IDs, category, concise facts, immediate safety concern, and requested help. Avoid asking reporters to resend sensitive information already in the service.

Triage model

Use a simple operational priority model, to be approved by the pilot owner:

- **Urgent:** credible immediate safety threat or active exposure of sensitive data. Route to trust owner and technical lead immediately; consider restricting the affected interaction while assessing.
- **High:** credible harassment, impersonation, or materially misleading task affecting active users. Assign same-day review during pilot coverage.
- **Standard:** task quality, spam, or conduct concern without immediate ongoing harm. Review in the next operating cycle.
- **Low:** product feedback or non-urgent disagreement. Log and route to the appropriate owner.

Set actual coverage hours and response targets before launch; these are not established by the prototype.

Review procedure

1. Acknowledge the report and assess whether the concern is ongoing or urgent.
2. Review only relevant product records and preserve an internal reference to the evidence.

3. Seek clarification from involved parties when safe and appropriate; do not disclose reporter details without need.
4. Apply the least restrictive action that addresses the immediate risk: request listing edits, pause task visibility, restrict messaging, or temporarily limit an account action if the product supports it.
5. Record the reason, action, operator, timestamp, and next review point.
6. Inform affected users of the outcome at an appropriate level without disclosing another person's private report.
7. Escalate uncertain/high-impact cases to the designated business owner; do not promise outcomes beyond Bridge's defined role.

Task quality controls

Before publication, check that a task has a clear deliverable, skills, budget and currency, deadline, and contact path. Reject or return tasks that request credentials, payment from applicants, unrelated personal data, or activity outside Bridge's approved pilot scope. Define prohibited work categories with the business owner before opening task posting broadly.

Profile signals and verification

The prototype includes rating and verified labels, but no definitions. Until an evidence process exists:

- Do not present a badge as identity or competence verification without a defined check and expiry/recheck process.
- Do not invent ratings or completion scores.
- Show only metrics derived from documented records and explain what they measure.
- Provide an escalation route for inaccurate profile information.

Account restrictions and appeals

If a restriction is required, record the reason, affected capabilities, duration/review date, and decision owner. Notify the user where safe and appropriate. Provide a contact for review. Final enforcement policy, appeal timings, and evidence standards must be set by the Bridge owner.

Safety incident and data exposure

- Tell the technical lead what product objects or flows may be exposed; do not circulate secrets in chat or issue notes.
- Limit further exposure where possible while preserving necessary investigation evidence.
- Assign a single incident lead and record actions in the incident log.
- Follow the Technical Operations Runbook for service/security incidents.
- Escalate uncertain external reporting decisions to the designated business owner; this guide does not define those decisions.

Operational readiness checklist

- Named trust owner and backup.
- Monitored report intake and stated pilot coverage hours.
- Approved restricted-activity/task checklist.
- Ability to pause a task and restrict a conversation or account action, or a documented manual workaround.
- Internal incident record with restricted access.
- User communication templates for acknowledgment, clarification, restriction, and closure.
- Clear route for urgent concerns and technical incidents.

Decisions to resolve

Who is eligible for the pilot; what work is prohibited; which verification checks exist; whether the rating/verified UI will be hidden; which moderator actions are available; what response coverage the team can sustain; how blocking/reporting works; and who owns disputes over work quality or payment.